

High-chance portions - culture-arch

Combined original study articles for this topic's highest-probability PYQ themes.

Temple & Indo-Islamic Architecture

~36% · Temple styles · Indo-Islamic features · Monuments

Why UPSC asks this

Feature -> example -> dynasty matching is the culture-architecture exam pattern.

Temple grammar

Plan, elevation, mandapa, garbhagriha. Regional schools (Odisha, Solanki, Chandela, Chola). Rock-cut to structural transition.

Indo-Islamic

Arcuate techniques, decorative calligraphy/geometry, garden tombs. Dynasty - monument pairs drilled weekly.

Map / list facts

- Khajuraho, Konark, Brihadeeswara, Shore Temple
- Qutb complex, Fatehpur Sikri, Taj

Must remember

- Nagara (north) shikhara; Dravida (south) vimana/gopuram; Vesara hybrid debates
- Arch, dome, minaret, jaali, char bagh

Educational prioritisation heuristic - not an official UPSC prediction. (c) UPSC IAS Study Hub original notes.